



Tutorial 3; Physical Chemistry

Q1. The hydrogenic Hamiltonian for the electron with mass m_e and nucleus with mass m_N is:

$$H = \hat{E}_{k,electron} + \hat{E}_{k,nucleus} + \hat{V} = -\frac{\hbar^2}{2m_e} \nabla_e^2 - \frac{\hbar^2}{2m_N} \nabla_N^2 - \frac{Ze^2}{4\pi\epsilon_0 r}$$

Here r is the distance of the electron from the nucleus and ϵ_0 is the vacuum permittivity. Show that the same can be written as,

$$H = -\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \nabla_{c.m.}^2 - \frac{\hbar^2}{2\mu} \nabla^2 - \frac{Ze^2}{4\pi\epsilon_0 r}. \text{ The terms have their usual meanings.}$$

Q2. Find the mean radius of an electron in the 1s orbital of H-atom. The

wavefunction, $\Psi = \frac{1}{(\pi a_0^3)^{1/2}} e^{-r/a_0}$ and $\int_0^\infty r^3 e^{-2r/a_0} dr = \frac{3a_0^4}{8}$ and

$$4\pi = \int_0^\pi \int_0^{2\pi} \sin \theta d\theta d\varphi. \text{ Also, } a_0 = 0.529 \text{ \AA}$$

Q3. In $H_2C=CH_2$, the carbon atoms are sp^2 hybridized. The central carbon atoms have electronic configuration $1s^2 2s^2 2p^2$. Find out the other two hybridized orbitals if one of them is $h_1 = (1/3)^{1/2} \{s + 2^{1/2} p_y\}$. Also, schematically draw the skeleton of one of the carbon atom hybrid orbitals and then show that these orbitals generate a bond angle of 120° .

Q4. Consider an electron (particle) on a ring. Write the one-electron Hamiltonian for the system. Find the normalized wavefunction (general expression), quantum numbers and energy (generalized expression) of the electron. Use the cyclic boundary condition: $\Psi(\varphi + 2\pi) = \Psi(\varphi)$. What is the expression for the wavelength of excitation between the first two energy states?